

आलोक रंजन, भा. पु. से.
निदेशक

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FOREWORD

The concept of prisons, as a secure place where offenders are kept and undergo punishment, has significantly changed over time. Historically, incarceration was seen primarily as a form of strict retribution. However, this view is gradually changing in the modern era. The shift is marked by a move away from harsh punitive measures and the introduction of systems that reward positive behaviour. This transformation aims to rehabilitate prisoners, helping them reintegrate into society upon their release, and offering them alternative livelihoods.

It is with great pride that I present the 29th edition of 'Prison Statistics India-2023', a flagship publication of the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB). Since its inception in 1995, this publication consistently provides a detailed statistical overview and insightful analysis of various aspects of prisons as correctional services and prisoner demographics in India.

This report is an important reference for stakeholders both within India and internationally. I am confident that this report, with its in-depth data compilation, will prove invaluable in shaping policies that enhance the effectiveness of our criminal justice system. It will also serve as a vital resource for policymakers, parliamentarians, researchers, and other

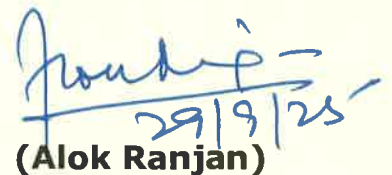
stakeholders, offering critical insights into conditions of these correctional services, inmate demographics, and post-release rehabilitation strategies.

I extend my heartfelt thanks to all Directors General, Inspectors General of Prisons and Correctional Services across States and Union Territories for their collaboration with the Bureau. Their diligent efforts in providing accurate and validated data have been indispensable to this report's success.

I also wish to express my sincere gratitude to the officers and staff of the Bureau's Statistical Branch for their dedication and teamwork. Their commitment to data collection, analysis, and publication of this report has played a pivotal role in its completion.

The digital version of the 2023 report, with additional details, is available on the NCRB website: <https://ncrb.gov.in>

We welcome feedback from stakeholders which will help improve future publications, ensuring that they remain relevant, effective, and impactful.



(Alok Ranjan)

29th September, 2025

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